Microsoft 365 Copilot

Analytics — Executive Briefing

What analytics are available, what decisions to make, and how to measure ROI

Document Property	Value
Section	Strategy
Audience	CIO, Solution Architect, Business Leaders
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How This Document Fits

This is a **Strategy** guide. Read this before deployment to understand what Copilot analytics capabilities exist and what decisions your organisation needs to make. Once decisions are made, hand off to your IT team with the Admin Setup Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy (you are here)	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

1. What Copilot Analytics Can Tell You

Microsoft 365 Copilot includes **five** analytics tiers, each serving different stakeholders. They build on each other progressively — you don't need all five to get started.

Tier 1

M365 Admin Center Reports

IT Admins

License & usage tracking

No setup needed

↓

Tier 2

Copilot Dashboard

Leaders & Managers

ROI, Adoption, Sentiment

1+ licenses

↓

Tier 3

Copilot Analytics Reports

Leaders & Analysts

Out-of-the-box reports

Dashboard access

↓

Tier 4

Agent Dashboard

Leaders & Analysts

Agent adoption & usage

50+ licenses (advanced)

↓

Tier 5

Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

Analysts

Custom queries & reports

Viva Insights license

Progressive implementation: Each tier builds on the previous. All tiers share organizational data and privacy settings.

Which Dashboard Answers Which Question?

Dashboard	Best For	Setup Time	Key Capability
Admin Center Reports	IT Admins tracking license usage	None (built-in)	User-level license utiliz
Copilot Dashboard	Business leaders measuring ROI	Up to 7 days	Copilot Assisted Hours
Copilot Analytics Reports	Leaders wanting targeted insights	Same as Dashboard	Out-of-the-box deep-c
Agent Dashboard	Leaders tracking agent adoption	Same as Dashboard	Agent-specific usage &
Advanced Analytics (Power BI)	Analysts doing deep-dive analysis	1–2 weeks	Before/after adoption c

Level-of-Effort Summary

Tier	Active Config	Wait/Processing	Ongoing Maintenance	Personas Ne
Admin Center	15–30 min	72 hours	None	Global Admir
Copilot Dashboard	2–4 hours	Up to 7 days	Monthly org data refresh	GA, AI Admir
Copilot Analytics Reports	None (auto)	Same as Dashboard	None	Dashboard a
Agent Dashboard	10 min (verify)	Same as Dashboard	None	AI Admin, co
Advanced Analytics	4–8 hours	Query-dependent	Monthly refresh + query re-runs	Insights Adm

Implementation Timeline

- **Day 1:** Admin Center reports available (~72 hours after first Copilot usage)
- **Day 7:** Copilot Dashboard + Copilot Analytics Reports fully populated (if prerequisites met)
- **Day 7:** Agent Dashboard available (on by default as part of Viva Insights web app)
- **Week 2+:** Advanced Analytics operational (after org data upload and query setup)

2. Decisions You Need to Make

2.1 Pre-Configuration Discovery Questions

Before your IT team touches any configuration, you should be able to answer these:

#	Question	Why It Matters
1	How many M365 Copilot licenses are **assigned** (not purchased)?	1+ for core dashboard; 50+ for adv
2	Is the Entra ID manager hierarchy populated for most users?	Determines automatic vs. manual c
3	Do you have an HR data export available (department, function, location)?	Required for group-level filtering a
4	Has anyone been assigned the AI Administrator role?	Required to manage dashboard ac
5	Do you have compliance/legal requirements to exclude specific users?	Drives exclusion list configuration (
6	Has Copilot already been rolled out, or is it pre-deployment?	Before/after analysis needs 4 week
7	Do you use Viva Glint or Viva Pulse for employee surveys?	Enables sentiment page with filters
8	What is the primary reporting need: Copilot-only or broader productivity?	Determines whether standalone Vi
9	Are you deploying Copilot agents / Copilot Studio agents?	Determines whether Agent Dashbo
10	Who are the target report consumers (IT admins, BU leaders, analysts)?	Drives which tiers to prioritize

2.2 Decision Framework

1. Do you need user-level license utilization data? → Start with **Admin Center Reports**
2. Do you have 1+ assigned Copilot licences AND want ROI metrics? → Enable **Copilot Dashboard** (50+ for advanced features)
3. Do leaders want ready-to-use targeted reports? → **Copilot Analytics Reports** (auto-available with Dashboard)
4. Are you deploying agents (Copilot Studio, etc.)? → Enable **Agent Dashboard**
5. Do you need before/after adoption analysis or custom segmentation? → Configure **Advanced Analytics**

TIP: Progressive Implementation

Most customers benefit from implementing all tiers progressively. Start with Admin Center (immediate), add Copilot Dashboard + Analytics Reports (week 1), then Advanced Analytics (week 2+) for comprehensive coverage.

3. Capability Comparison

Capability	Admin Center	Copilot Dashboard	Analytics Reports	Agent Dashb
Primary Audience	IT Admins	Leaders, Managers	Leaders, Analysts	Leaders, Ana
Minimum Licenses	Any (1+)	1+ Copilot (50+ for advanced)	Same as Dashboard	50 Copilot C
Setup Complexity	None	Low–Medium	None (auto)	Low
Data Latency	~72 hours	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days
User-Level Tracking	Yes	No (group-level)	No (group-level)	No (group-le
ROI Metrics	No	Assisted Hours/Value	Yes (targeted)	No
Sentiment Data	No	Yes	Yes	No
Agent Tracking	No	Preview	No	Yes
Before/After Analysis	No	No	No	No
Export Capabilities	CSV	CSV (de-identified, 6 months weekly)	Limited	Limited

4. Who Does What (RACI)

Activity	Global Admin	AI Admin	Insights Admin	Insights Analyst	Business Lea
Assign Copilot/Viva licences	R/A	–	–	–	C
Assign Insights Admin/Analyst roles	R/A	–	–	–	–
Enable/disable VFAM policies	–	R/A	–	–	–
Configure Manager Settings	–	C	R/A	–	I
Upload organizational data	C	–	R/A	–	I
Configure privacy / group size	–	C	R/A	–	I
Create exclusion lists	–	R/A	–	–	C
Run Advanced Analytics queries	–	–	C	R/A	I
Delegate dashboard access	–	–	–	–	R/A
View & act on insights	I	–	–	C	R/A

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

5. Key Concepts for Leaders

5.1 Copilot Assisted Hours & Value

The primary ROI metric. Composed of three categories:

Category	What's counted	Assistance factor
Meeting Summaries	Duration of each meeting summarized by Copilot	Actual meeting duration (variable)
Search & Summaries	Chat prompts, email/doc summaries, analysis	6 minutes per action
Content Creation	Draft email, Draft in Word, Create presentation	6 minutes per action

Assisted Value = Assisted Hours × Hourly Rate (default $72/hour, configurable per session).

5.2 Licensing — What You Get with Copilot

Every M365 Copilot licence **automatically includes** the Viva Insights service plan at no additional cost. This covers all analytics capabilities. A separate Viva Insights purchase is only needed to analyse employees who do *not* have Copilot licences.

5.3 Privacy by Design

- **No individual tracking:** All dashboard data is aggregated at group level
- **Minimum group size:** Default 10 (configurable down to 5)
- **Differential privacy:** Automatically applied to protect individuals
- **Exclusion lists:** Remove specific users from all analytics

5.4 Known Metric Underreporting

Microsoft has acknowledged two data collection issues. No action needed — data auto-corrects after the affected windows.

Affected Metrics	Affected Period
Email features (drafts, summaries)	June 1, 2025 – February 18, 2026
Meeting features (summaries, recap)	September 6 – November 3, 2025

6. Scope & Limitations

In Scope

- Microsoft 365 Copilot applications: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, Loop, OneNote, Edge, Copilot Chat
- Five monitoring tiers: Admin Center, Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, Advanced Analytics
- License utilization, ROI measurement, sentiment analysis, agent adoption

Out of Scope

- Other Copilot products: Copilot for Sales, Copilot for Service, GitHub Copilot, Security Copilot
- **Copilot Chat (Free) users** — E3/E5 users without the paid Copilot add-on now have visibility via the Copilot Chat filter on the Copilot Dashboard (available with 1+ Copilot licences; Copilot Chat reporting must be enabled). However, they are not tracked by Admin Center Copilot reports or Viva Insights queries.
- Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time) — see Collaboration Analysis Guide

> **UPDATE (April 2026): Copilot Chat Users Are Now Visible**
>
> The Copilot Dashboard now includes a **License filter** that lets you toggle between **Microsoft 365 Copilot** and **Copilot Chat** views. The Copilot Chat filter shows insights for M365 E3/E5 users who use the free Copilot Chat app without the paid add-on. This addresses the previous blind spot for free Copilot Chat adoption. Available with 1+ Copilot licences; Copilot Chat reporting must be enabled by an admin.

7. What to Read Next

If you need to...	Read this
Decide your HR data / org data approach	Data Strategy (Strategy layer)
Understand multi-agency architecture options	Multi-Agency Decision Guide (Strategy layer)
Hand off to IT for implementation	Admin Setup Guide (Setup layer)
Understand how to connect HR data	Data Onboarding Guide (Setup layer)
Learn to read the dashboards	Dashboard & Reports Guide (Operate layer)
Understand billing and licence lifecycle	Billing Operations (Operate layer)

Disclaimer

This guide is provided as a procedural reference and may not reflect the latest product changes. Always refer to the official Viva Insights and Microsoft 365 Copilot documentation on Microsoft Learn for the most up-to-date information.